

You have to limit these costs, which isn't easy, and you need to earn higher rates of return to offset them. You can do it, with a little luck, if you let time work for you.

The typical investor is betting against time. He buys a stock. He hopes the stock will go up . . . and that he will then get out before time takes it back down again.

But if you're willing to let time help you, you can wait long enough to see what direction the *market* is taking. The big trends are long-term trends. The last big bull market on Wall Street lasted 25 years. The bear market before that lasted 16 years. The bull market in bonds began in 1983 . . . and it's still going on. These are the trends that pay off. And if you listen and watch carefully, you can see them coming and going. And you can use them to limit your losses and improve your gains.

But that is not the most important thing. Time also has a devastating effect on families. People grow old. They're no longer able to do the work required to maintain a dynamic, capable family. New family members are often less able or distracted. Husbands, wives, children—every new family member comes with risks attached. And over time, one or two of those time bombs is bound to blow up.

More important than the money, the family has to be kept strong and healthy. A strong family can make money. A weak family can't even hold onto money that someone else made. A strong family can build and develop business opportunities. A weak family can only fumble and destroy them. A strong family can meet its financial, business, and other challenges. A weak family collapses under the pressure of them.

So how do you use time to make sure you have a strong family?

Well, that's the real secret of Old Money families. And it's a story that is scarcely understood by anyone. The key is that Old Money families are very, very different from regular families. And they are not at all what most people think they are.

They are not "conservative," in the usual sense. Instead, they are active and forward looking.

They may or may not live in luxury. But they always take care to live well.